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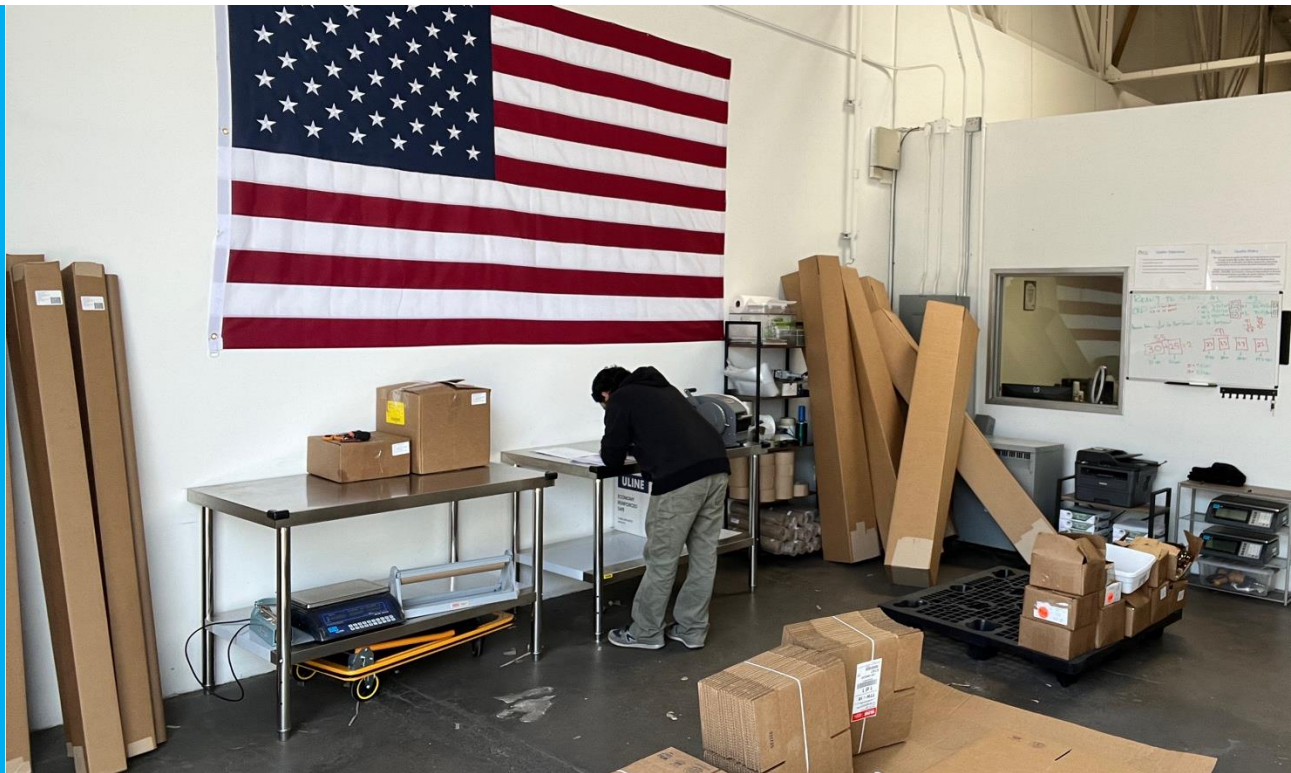
GovScraper Vertical Guide:
**YOUR FAST TRACK PLAYBOOK
TO WINNING DLA CONTRACTS**

By MeND Sourcing Solutions

July 2025

GovScraper Vertical Guide: **YOUR FAST-TRACK PLAYBOOK TO WINNING DoD CONTRACTS**

By Tristan Thomas – Founder of MeND Sourcing Solutions and GovScraper



PREFACE



Working with the DLA is challenging and full of obstacles that no one prepares you for.

Let's fix that. The content in this guide is our proven method to working with the DLA that has helped us generate **\$7+ million in awards** and land **more than 200 contracts** through the DLA.

We'll walk you through the step-by-step process when bidding on DLA RFQs. Whether you're just getting started or looking to sharpen your strategy, it's designed to make you more efficient and help you win more.

Our intention isn't a secret: we want to earn your trust and introduce you to GovScraper, the platform we built to automate and streamline this entire bidding process. It is a tool we built out of frustration pulling data from RFQs – we hated it, so we built a tool to eliminate that pain point. GovScraper is a tool our team uses daily to win more contracts. In fact, we've 10x'd our business using GovScraper going from \$200,000 in awards in Q1 of 2024 to \$2,000,000 in Q1 of 2025! If it works for us, why wouldn't it work for you?

But before we ask for your trust, we want to earn it by giving you this guide.

We remember what it was like starting out. We wish a company had taken the time to walk us through the process back then. It would have saved us countless hours and a ton of money. Now, we want to be that company for you.

So, here's our ask: Use the guide. Test it. And if it helps move the needle like we believe it will, give GovScraper a try. We're confident it will give you the traction you've been looking for. At the end of the day, our mission is simple: we want to help you win.

Use this guide as a tool in your contracting arsenal - we hope it serves you well.

Sincerely,



Tristan Thomas

Founder, GovScraper & MeND Sourcing Solutions

Why Government Contracting with the DLA?

In 2024, the Defense Logistics Agency (DLA) awarded \$773.68 billion in contracts to 108,899 companies. Over 23% of that went to Small Business Set-Asides!

DLA also worked with 8,500 suppliers and awarded an average of 10,000 contracts daily.

This playbook turns the tedious regulations into a 8-step, field-tested system you can run in weeks, not months, to win your first (or fiftieth) contract

The 8-Step GovScraper Workflow to Bidding and Fulfilling Awards

PDFs Tools can be found within the Community Forum in GovScraper LITE
Membership starting at \$35 / month

Step	Key Outputs	Fast-Track Tools & Tips
1 Find the Right Federal Supply Class (FSCs)	Select 3 - 5 high-probability FSC categories.	FSC_Code_Listing.pdf
2 Research, Select, & Vet Vendors	Create a list of qualified MFGs or distributors per FSC.	- FSC_Vendor_Worksheet.pdf - Vendor_Checklist.pdf
3 Send Request for Quotations to Vendors	Review Gov't RFQs and send RFQ to qualified vendors.	- Email_Template_Guide.pdf - Vendor_Checklist.pdf
4 Receive Price and Lead Time & Submit Bid	Factor bid price with all expenses and your margin. Then, submit bid through DIBBS.	Price_Bid_Tool.xls
5 Provide Traceability Request	When requested, complete traceability to prove sourcing.	- YouTube – MeND Sourcing - Vendor_Capability_Template.pdf - Traceability_Example_1.png
6 Win and Review the Award - Send out Purchase Order	Review award and send purchase order with “flow-downs”.	- YouTube – MeND Sourcing - Award_Review_Checklist.pdf
7 Receive, Inspect, and Package Items	Parts inspected, packed via ASTM or Mil-STD-2073 with Mil-STD-129 labels attached.	- GovPacking.com for material, request for packaging quote, etc. - Mil_STD_Decoder.pdf
8 Ship, Track, & Invoice	Complete VSM, notate tracking info, and submit Receiving Report & Invoice through WAWF.	- VSM_How_to_Guide.pdf - Receiving_Report_Sample.pdf - YouTube – MeND Sourcing

STEP 1

Find the Right Federal Supply Class (FSC)

The four-digit FSC (Federal Supply Class) identifies the category of a specific item. To determine your FSC focus, start with the products where you have a competitive edge. Whether through industry experience, supplier relationships, or market knowledge, your relationships are a great starting point. Use the FSC Code List PDF to browse categories and select up to five that align with your strengths.

Once selected, identify vendors with proven capability to manufacture or supply items within those FSCs.

To find active government contracting opportunities, use sites like SAM.gov, DIBBS, and FedMall. Reviewing RFQs can be time consuming – so to streamline the process, tools like **GovScraper** save hours of research by automatically pulling RFQs, tracking bid data, and offering KPI tools to help you scale your quoting efforts effectively.



STEP 2

Research, Select, & Vet Vendors

Once you've selected your FSCs, the next step is identifying qualified vendors who can supply supplies the DLA is requesting.

Use the *Vendor Checklist* to understand more about your vendor and have the confidence they can be a prime partner moving forward. Your vendor's performance in providing you the correct item will directly impact your Supplier Performance Risk System (SPRS) score.





STEP 3

Send Request for Quotation (RFQ)

The next step is to contact vendors and request pricing and availability. But sending an RFQ alone isn't enough! Your success often depends on your ability to build genuine relationships with suppliers.

Strong relationships are the key to securing competitive pricing and consistent responses to your RFQs. If a vendor doesn't know you, you're more likely to receive a "No Bid" or no response. But when trust is established, vendors are more likely to prioritize your request.

Keep these in mind:

- Do not just send an email and wait for a response. It's your responsibility to get a quote back - don't be afraid to give them a call and engage
- A 3-minute conversation can accomplish more than a long email thread
- Your goal is to connect with a real person - ideally someone in government sales
- If you don't hear back, follow up respectfully, ask for an update, and be transparent about your timeline and requirements to submit a bid with the DLA
- Make it clear that you are not just looking for a one-time quote and seeking to build a long-term, mutually beneficial relationship
- Always communicate your "Value Add" - why should they quote you?

Vendors are more likely to respond and support your efforts when they feel there's a relationship, not just a one-time request.

The DLA requires potential contractors without a track record of fulfilling contracts successfully to fill out a Vendor Capability Questionnaire for specific solicitations. We have completed this form for many solicitations early on - it is their way of assessing your ability to perform and complete the contract.

STEP 4

Receive Price and Lead Time & Submit Bid

Once your vendors respond, you'll receive two key details: their price and lead time. These form the foundation of your bid price.

Take the time to review each responses thoroughly:

- Confirm part number, quantity they can provide, and any additional cost (cert fees, etc.)
- Ensure the vendor can meet any special requirements (traceability, certifications, FATs, PLTs, etc.)

Before submitting your bid:

- Factor in all your expenses into your bid price
- Add your markup or profit margin, but aim to stay competitive
- Double-check every calculation. Packaging costs are often underestimated - work with a packaging house you can trust and keeps you competitive

This is where your preparation pays off. A precise, timely, and well-structured bid greatly increases your chance of winning and delivering with confidence.

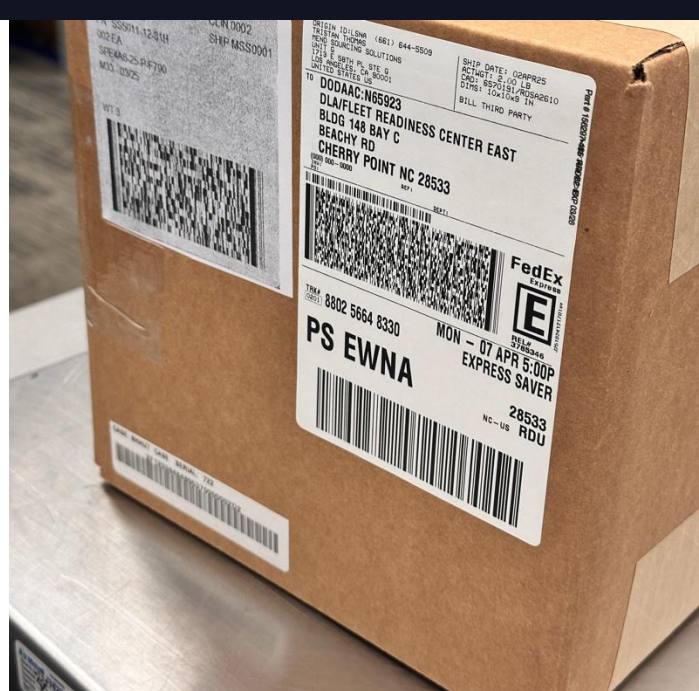


STEP 5

Provide Traceability Request

Once you submit your bid, the government may request traceability documentation to verify you can supply the exact item listed in the solicitation.

This is a strong signal that your bid is under serious consideration. At this stage, the government is focused on minimizing risk and confirming you're a reliable contractor for the award.



To provide traceability, you'll typically need:

- A quote or RFQ from your vendor that clearly shows the part number, quantity, and (at times) price. This can be a PDF or even a screenshot of the email reply from the vendor – this is dependent upon the contracting officer's preferences
- Documentation from a verified source – either the OEM or a distributor with direct access to the specified item

It does not always need to come directly from the manufacturer, but it must confirm you can supply the correct part from a legitimate, traceable source.

Lastly, if your company is new to government contracting or your CAGE code is not yet recognized by the DLA, they may also request a Vendor Capability Questionnaire (VCQ). This form helps them evaluate your legitimacy and ability to fulfill the award.



With the VCQ, be prepared to:

- Detail how you'll source the item
- Outline your company's structure and operations
- Provide references

Demonstrating credibility and traceability early increases your chances of winning the award and being approved with delays.

STEP 6

Win and Review the Award - Send out Purchase Order

Congratulations, you've won the award! Now it's time to thoroughly review the contract and begin fulfillment by issuing a Purchase Order (PO) to your vendor.

While the award may closely resemble the original RFQ in structure, with part numbers and quantities in familiar places, every page must be reviewed carefully.

Why? Because hidden within the contract language could be:

- Specific sampling or inspection methods
- Packaging and preservation material requirements
- Acceptance or inspection location (Origin vs. Destination)
- Mandatory clauses and required certifications
- Delivery due date
- Flow-down requirements you must pass along to your vendor

Once you've verified that all contract terms match your expectations, you can proceed with creating and issuing your PO.



When Sending Your PO to the Vendor:

- Ensure the PO matches the award exactly - including part number, quantities, delivery terms, and within the due date
- Flow down all applicable clauses and requirements
- Clearly state the agreed payment terms
- Never prepay unless the parts are ready for pickup or shipment
- Use Net 30 or pay-on-pickup terms to minimize risk

Pro Tip:

A well-structured PO protects your business. Spell out contract references and use simple language to communicate.

STEP 7

Receive, Inspect, and Package Items

Once your parts arrive, your next step is inspection and packaging. This process is critical to meeting government compliance, avoiding shipment rejections, and maintaining your reputation as a trusted DLA contractor.

Start with a basic “Kind, Count, and Condition” inspection:

- **Kind:** Are you receiving the correct part number(s)?
- **Count:** Is the quantity exactly what was ordered?
- **Condition:** Are the parts new, undamaged, the condition requested within the contract?

But keep in mind that some contracts require more than just visual checks. In some cases, additional inspection, such as verifying documentation, testing electrical components, or confirming traceability markings, may be required.

Then, review your packaging requirements:

- If your contract requires ASTM or MIL-STD-2073, you must adhere to those standards precisely - including container types, cushioning, wrap material, and preservation methods.
- These are mandatory specifications. Failure to comply may result in rejection, returns, and delayed payment of invoices.

If you're unsure, contact MeND Sourcing – our team can guide you or even handle the packaging for you or visit www.GovPacking.com to get assistance.

Why it matters: Proper inspection and packaging keeps your shipment compliant, invoices approved and paid, and your SPRS score strong.



STEP 8

Ship, Track, & Invoice

Once your parts are inspected and packaged internally, it's time to ship, monitor delivery, and submit your receiving report and invoice.

Start by reviewing your contract award, especially the FOB (Origin or Destination) and the shipment DoDAAC (Department of Defense Activity Address Code).

What is FOB Origin and FOB Destination and why does it matter?

- **FOB Origin:** The government arranges and pays for shipping. You'll likely need to use the Vendor Shipment Module (VSM) to generate exterior labels and documentation.
- **FOB Destination:** You are responsible for shipping costs and logistics to the end destination. You must select your carrier and ensure on-time delivery to the receiving address. Use VSM to generate exterior labels and documentation.

Once the parts are shipped, you must complete two final tasks to get paid:

- **Submit a Receiving Report**
 - This notifies the government that your items have shipped and are on their way.
- **Submit an Invoice**
 - Once received, this kicks off the payment process through WAWF (Wide Area Workflow)

Both the receiving report and invoice are submitted electronically through WAWF, the DLA's online payment portal.

Pro Tip: Most contracts pay within 30 days after the invoice is accepted, but only if all documentation is correct and submitted promptly.

Careful attention to shipping details and timely invoicing ensures smooth closeout and reliable payment and sets you up for repeat awards.

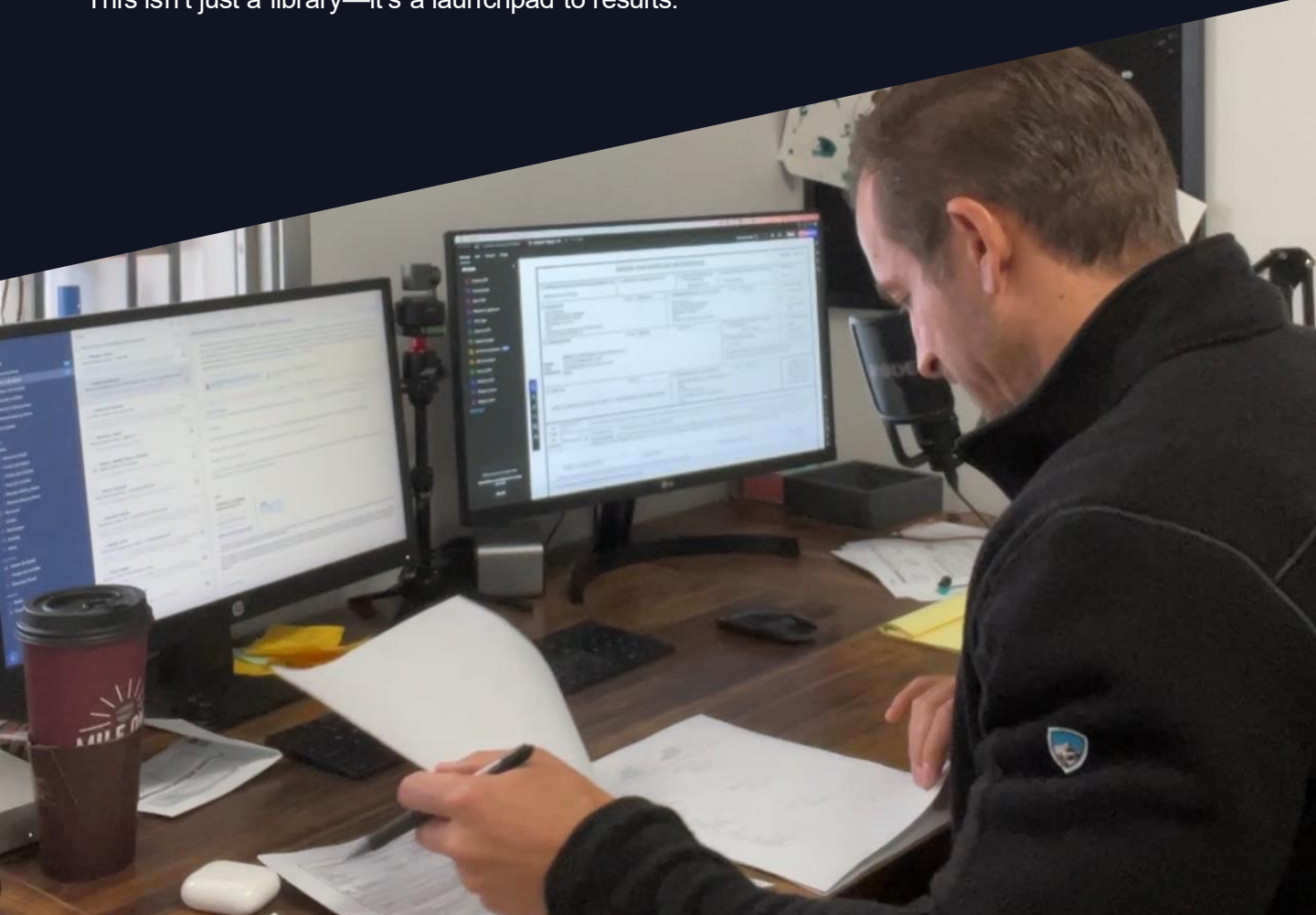


Tools to Flatten the Learning Curve

Government contracting—especially with the DLA—can be complex. That's why we've built tools to simplify the process, shorten the learning curve, and help you win faster:

- GovScraper – Instantly extracts key RFQ data and delivers organized opportunities saving hours of manual research and eliminates the use of excel spreadsheet tracking!
- GovPacking – Simplifies complex military packaging standards so you ship right the first time. Request packaging quotes, purchase Mil-STD-129 labels, and packaging material
- Resource Vault – A curated collection of templates, tools, and step-by-step guides available to all Lite Plan members found within the Community Forum. Inside, you'll find the exact tools we use daily when quoting

This isn't just a library—it's a launchpad to results.



Case Study

From Confused to Contract-Winner - How Hands-On Training Transformed a New Contractor's Journey

Client Background

Before discovering GovScraper and MeND Sourcing's training program, our client, ABHB was navigating the world of state and local contracts, but with minimal progress with the DLA. Despite watching countless YouTube videos and submitting a few bids through DIBBS, the complexity of the solicitations left them uncertain and stuck.

"We were somewhat brand new to government contracting on a federal level. We had watched numerous videos on the subject and had submitted a few bids on DIBBS. But it just wasn't clicking."

Challenge

Like many new contractors, they faced the overwhelming nature of the DIBBS platform, the bidding process, and the lack of personalized guidance. Online resources gave them fragments of understanding, but not the full picture.

Solution: In-Person, Practical Training

After discovering MeND Sourcing through YouTube, the owner of ABHB enrolled in the 2-day, in-person government contracting training in Los Angeles, California.



"The training was like a light bulb moment for us. It clarified so much and we were able to finally understand the solicitation and what was needed."



"The training didn't just offer theory - it provided a step-by-step breakdown on bids, sourcing, packaging, and succeeding. It replaced confusion with clarity."



"The training gave us a clear, repeatable process. Started with choosing the right FSCs to bidding, winning awards and fulfilling the contract."

Ongoing Support & Accessibility

The support didn't stop after the 2-day session. The MeND Sourcing team continues to stay fully accessible to all GovScraper members – by phone and email to answer any questions.

"I'd rate their accessibility a 10 out of 10. They told me I could call anytime - and when I do, they take the time to answer my questions." - Yvrose Kankkunen w/ Afinius Health

Results

Since completing the training, students have gone on to win multiple government contracts - a major leap forward from those in the training. Long are the days of stalled bids and unanswered questions.

Would ABHB recommend the training?

- "Yes. Without a doubt."
- "We needed this training."
- "YouTube wasn't enough."
- "We'd rate the program a 10 out of 10."

3 Services We
Offer to Contractors

Gov  Scraper

Gov  Packing

Gov  Training

SUMMARY AND NEXT STEP

This guide is designed to give you a strong foundation on your path to becoming a trusted supplier for the DLA. If you're looking for additional support, as mentioned, we offer several powerful resources:

- **GovScraper** - streamlines the RFQ discovery and bidding process
- **GovPacking** – takes the confusion out of packing with a trusted partner
- **GovTraining** - a 2-day in-person workshop providing a deep dive into government contracting to help you bid with greater confidence and clarity.

If you have any questions or need guidance, do not hesitate to reach out - we're here to help you win Government Contracts.

Reach us at: sales@mendsourcing.com